Board 1
East Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ J 10 9 7 6 3
♦ K 3
♣ 5 4 2

♠ 5 4 2
♥ A K 4 2
♦ 8 5 2
♣ A Q 8

♠ A J 10 9 8
♥ 8
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ J 7 3

♠ K Q 6
♥ Q 5
♦ A J 7 4
♣ K 10 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			

2♥ by North
Lead: ♥8

The bidding has been as shown.

Surprise - you open 1NT. Partner responds 2♥. (no transfers in this lesson)

Pass. Partner has long ♥s (probably 6) and short points (fewer than 9). He has decided that 2♥ will be a better spot than 1NT. Trust him.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 9 7 5 3 ♥ 9 6 4 2 ♦ K 8 ♣ 4 2	
♠ J 8 ♥ Q J 10 7 3 ♦ J 5 3 ♣ A 7 3	N W E S	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K 5 ♦ A Q 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6
	♠ A 4 2 ♥ A 8 ♦ 10 9 6 2 ♣ Q J 8 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♣Q

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner replies 3♥. What do you say next?

With this bidding method, partner's bid shows at least 10 points and exactly 5 ♥s. He expects you to choose between 3NT and 4♥. Since you have just a doubleton in ♥s you choose 3NT.

NOTE: Jacoby Transfers are very useful for this type of hand.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K 5 ♦ A Q 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6	
♠ 5 4 ♥ Q 10 6 3 ♦ 9 8 ♣ Q 8 4 3 2	N W E S	♠ A 8 2 ♥ J 9 7 4 ♦ K J 10 5 3 ♣ J
	♠ J 10 9 7 3 ♥ A 8 2 ♦ 6 2 ♣ A 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	Pass
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown.

Yes this is exactly the same hand you held in Deal 8. You still open 1NT. This time partner responds 3♠.

Partner shows 10+ points and exactly 5 ♠s. This time, with 3-card support, you choose game in ♠s, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 7 5 3 ♥ A 10 9 6 ♦ 6 3 ♣ 7 5 2	
♠ K Q 6 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ Q 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6		♠ A 10 9 ♥ 8 3 ♦ A K J 10 8 2 ♣ J 8
	♠ J 4 2 ♥ J 7 5 2 ♦ 9 5 ♣ A Q 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
1NT	Pass	3♦	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♠7

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner says 3♦. It's your bid.

Partner has a great hand. A jump to 3 in a Minor suit almost always shows slam interest. But that's partner with interest, not you. You couldn't have a more minimum 1NT opening bid.

So you just return to 3NT. Partner gives up and passes.

Board 5
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ A 8 5 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A Q 8 7 5 4	
♠ J 10 9 2 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q 10 8 2 ♣ 3 2		♠ A 8 7 5 4 ♥ J 10 7 2 ♦ 9 6 5 ♣ J
	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ A 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♣ by North
Lead: ♦5

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

Board 6
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 10 4 3 ♥ A 10 ♦ J 10 3 2 ♣ K 8 4	
♠ K 9 6 ♥ K J 6 4 ♦ A Q 4 ♣ Q J 5		♠ Q 8 ♥ Q 9 8 7 3 2 ♦ 6 ♣ 10 9 6 3
	♠ A 7 5 2 ♥ 5 ♦ K 9 8 7 5 ♣ A 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
1NT	Pass	2♥	
All Pass			

2♥ by East
Lead: ♦5

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.